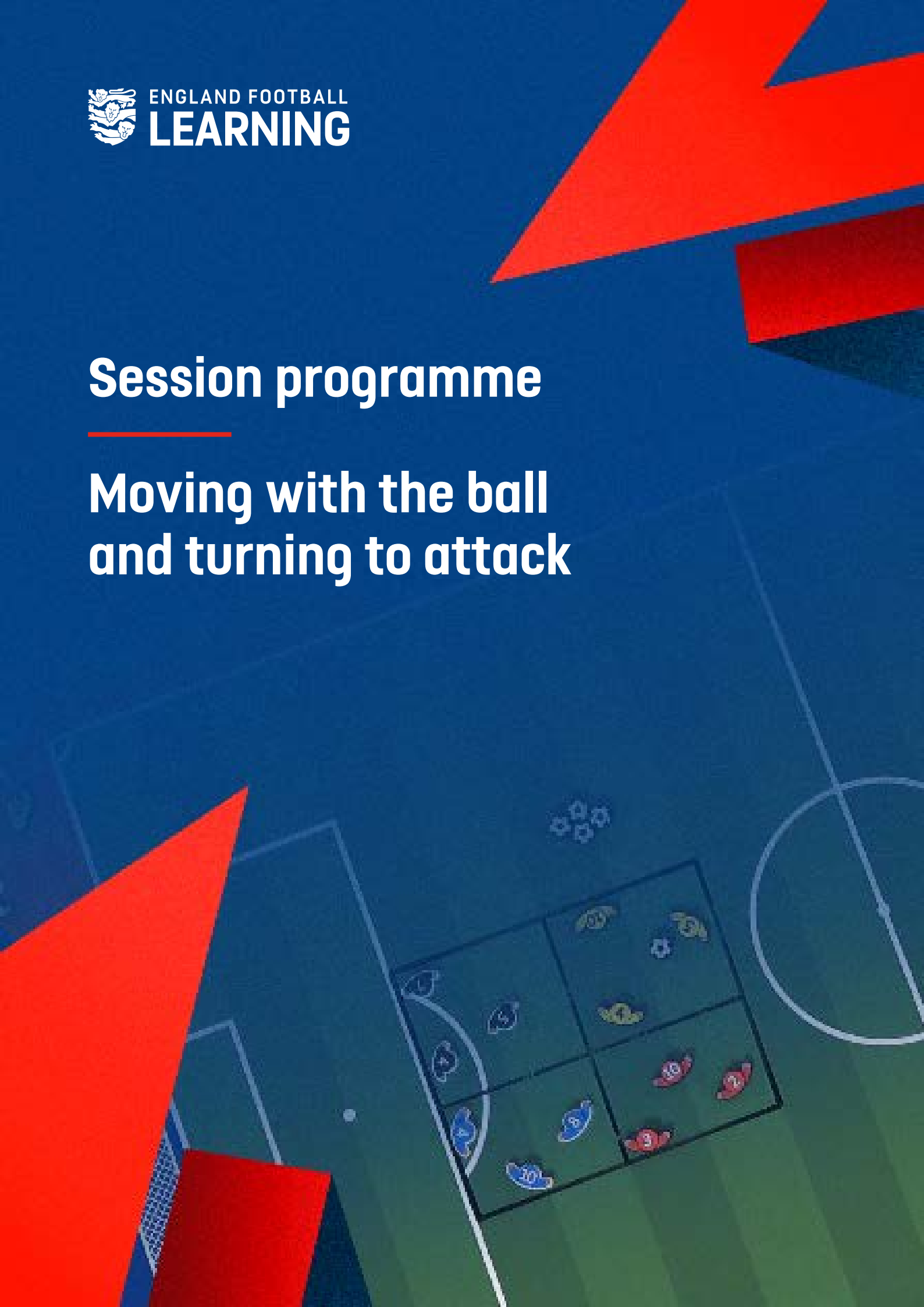


Session programme

Moving with the ball and turning to attack



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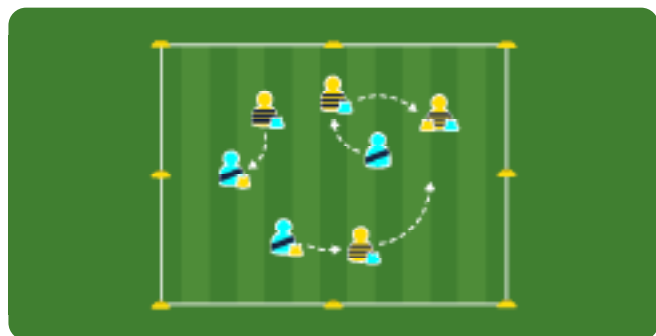
Week one: finding space to attack

This session will help players:

- recognise space to attack into
- work with a teammate to beat defenders
- improve decision-making skills when moving with the ball and turning.

Coaching points

- Ask players to think about how they can beat a defender using their movement or a teammate.
- Encourage players to look around to identify where the space is, where the opposition is, and where their teammates are.
- Encourage players to create passing angles by finding areas of space where the player on the ball can see them.
- Ask your players to think about how they time their movement. If they move too early, the defender may follow them and mark. If they move too late, the space may disappear, and the defender can intercept.
- Help the players understand the end zone game by relating it to positions on the pitch. Passing into a target player can represent a midfielder playing into the feet of a striker.



Arrival activity: bib steal

- Set up a 20x15-yard area.
- Each player has a bib tucked into their shorts in line with their hip.
- Players try to steal other bibs while protecting their own.
- If they steal a bib, they tuck that into their shorts.
- If they lose their bib, they try to get another one.



Practice one: double trouble

- Put a goal at each end of your 35x25-yard pitch.
- Have a keeper and a defender at one end with pairs of attackers opposite.
- Attackers move and combine to try to score.
- If the defender wins the ball, they work with the keeper to attack the opposite end.
- When play resets, the next pair have a go.



Practice two: end zone game

- Use the same area but use end zones instead of goals.
- Have a neutral target player in each end zone.
- Teams work together to get the ball to a target player to score a point.
- If they do, they get the ball back and try to get it to the target player at the other end to score again.



Practice three: small-sided game

- Use the same area again but use the goals at both ends.
- Players take part in a match to put their learning into action.

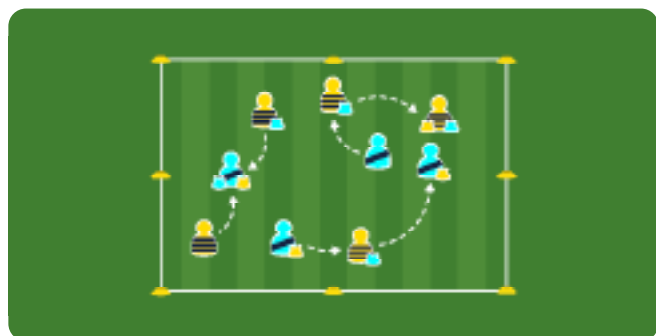
Week two: escaping the defender

This session will help players:

- develop their moving with the ball and turning skills
- use their speed and moving with the ball technique to attack space
- work with a teammate to beat defenders
- improve decision-making skills when moving with the ball and turning.

Coaching points

- Ask players to think about how they can beat a defender using their movement or a teammate.
- Set up a 'tactics zone' for double trouble. Use this space to speak to individual players about what you've seen and get them thinking about what they can do better next time.
- Encourage players to use their body to protect the ball by being in between the opponent and the ball.
- Encourage players to use their speed to move with the ball into space.
- When near a defender, get players to think about taking smaller touches and keeping the ball close to them. When there's space, encourage players to take bigger touches to drive into the space.



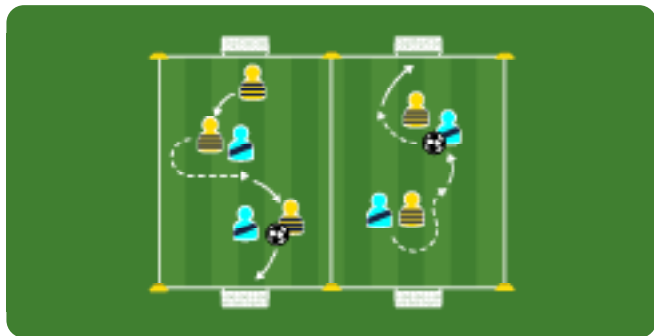
Arrival activity: bib steal

- Use half of your 35x25-yard pitch for the bib steal arrival activity.
- Each player has a bib tucked into their shorts in line with their hip.
- Players try to steal other bibs while protecting their own.
- If they lose their bib, they try to get another one.



Arrival activity: bib steal – continued

- To progress this activity, give a ball to each player and add in a safe zone.
- The aim of the game is the same, but players can go into the safe zone to be unopposed for a bit if they need to.



Practice one: small-sided game

- Play a small-sided game on each half of your pitch.
- Place a mini-goal, or use cones to create goals, on each side.
- This game gives players the chance to practise turning and dribbling with the ball.



Practice two: double trouble

- Use half of your pitch.
- Have a keeper and a defender at one end, with pairs of attackers at the other.
- Have an extra defender off the pitch. They swap with the other defender after each attacking pair has had a go.
- Attackers combine to try to score.
- When play resets, the next pair have their turn.
- If the defender wins the ball they dribble through some cones at the side or halfway to score.



Practice three: small-sided game

- Finish the session with a small-sided game using the whole pitch and a goal at each end.
- This gives players more space and opportunity to practise what they've been learning.

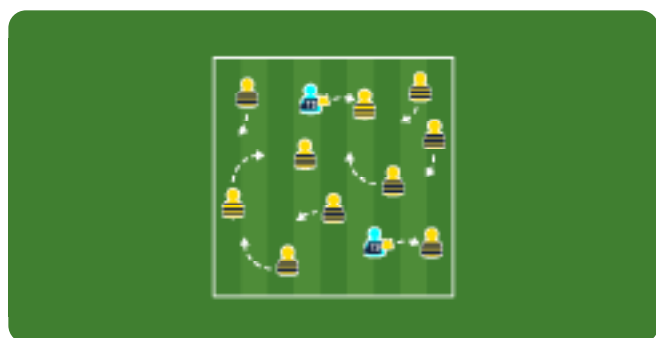
Week three: turning to play forward

This session will help players:

- develop their ability to twist, turn, dodge and weave
- work with a teammate to beat defenders
- improve decision-making skills when moving with the ball and turning.

Coaching points

- Ask players to think about how they can beat a defender using their movement or a teammate.
- When near a defender, get players to think about taking smaller touches and keeping the ball close to them. When there's space, encourage players to take bigger touches to drive into the space.
- Before receiving, encourage your players to adopt an open body shape to allow them to turn and play forward if they have space.
- Ask players to think about how they can use clever, disguised movements to lose a defender. They might move away from the ball to create space for them to drop into, for instance. Or they might move towards the ball to create space in behind for them to spin into.



Arrival activity: spiderweb tig

- Set up a 30x30-yard area.
- Choose two players to be taggers and give each a bib (spiderweb).
- To tag someone, they throw their spiderweb at them.
- If it connects with a player, the tagger gets a point.
- The others need to dodge the spiderwebs.
- The tagger with the most points wins.



Practice one: twist and turn

- Use the same space and split your group into two teams.
- Have one start on the outside of the area and one on the inside.
- Give the outside players a ball each.
- They pass to a player in the middle without a ball.
- They turn and move before passing to another outside player.



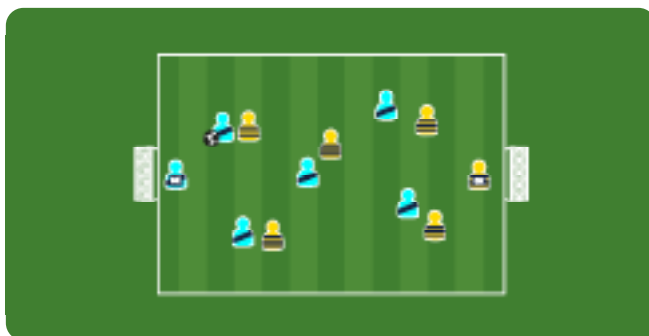
Practice one: twist and turn – continued

- Progress this practice by using cones to create different sized gates inside the area.
- Players on the inside need to control the ball, turn and dribble through a gate before passing the ball to a player on the outside.



Practice two: end zone game

- Place an end zone at each end of your pitch.
- Have a target player in each end zone.
- Teams work together to get the ball to their target player to score a point.
- Play restarts with the other team who try to work the ball to their own target player.



Practice three: small-sided game

- Finish the session with a small-sided game using the whole pitch and a goal at each end.
- This gives players the opportunity to put their moving with the ball and turning skills into practice.

Week four: scanning and turning

This session will help players:

- understand the importance of scanning before, during, and after turning
- work on different turns
- improve decision-making skills when moving with the ball and turning.

Coaching points

- Remind players to scan before, during, and after receiving the ball, so they know where and when to move and turn.
- Give players some examples of turns they could use to escape any interference, such as a 'Cruyff' turn, outside hook, or drag-back. Encourage them to use different types of turns when they're on the ball. Observe which turns they're using and offer support if needed.
- Coordination skills are key in the arrival activity. Ask players to think about their turns as they're throwing or retrieving their bibs.
- Ensure players understand the importance of keeping the ball close to their body when they receive and turn with the ball. Keeping a tight turning circle helps players when they face opposition or interference.



Arrival activity: spiderweb tag

- Set up a 40x35-yard area.
- Give everyone a ball and a bib (a spiderweb).
- To tag someone, players throw their spiderweb at another player's ball.
- If it connects, the tagger gets a point.
- They do this while trying to dodge other spiderwebs.
- The tagger with the most points wins.



Practice one: small-sided game

- Use the same area and add goals at each end.
- Split the area into three channels and make the middle one smaller to help players with pitch geography and to encourage them to receive and turn in tight areas.
- To score, the ball has to have travelled in at least two of the channels.



Practice two: criss-cross

- Use half of the previous area for this activity.
- Split players into three teams.
- Give each team a ball.
- Players keep moving and passing within the area in this unopposed with interference practice.
- Players need to complete a different turn each time they receive the ball.



Practice three: small-sided game

- Finish the session by returning to a small-sided game.
- This is an opportunity to notice if the players can put their learning into practice and have improved their ability to move with the ball and turn.

Week five: moving with deception

This session will help players:

- change direction and speed while moving with the ball
- scan for space to discover when and where to move and turn
- use deception and disguise to move with the ball and turn while under pressure.

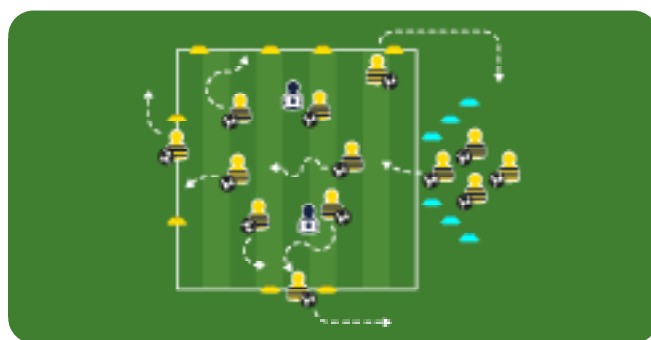
Coaching points

- Remind players to scan before, during and after receiving the ball, so they know where and when to move and turn.
- Support players to understand how a change in direction and speed can help them beat defenders and progress forward.
- Encourage players to use feints and body movement to disguise their intentions when moving with the ball.
- Ask players to think about when they can move forward with the ball, or when they may have to turn and utilise support players to play away from pressure.



Arrival activity: great escape

- Set up a 35x35-yard area.
- Put four different sized gates around the edge of the area and mark out a funnel using cones to act as an entrance point.
- Two players act as guards and start inside the area.
- The rest have a ball each and start in the funnel.



Arrival activity: great escape – continued

- Players with a ball must dribble into the area and try to escape through a gate for a point.
- The guards get a point for winning the ball off a player.
- Keep rotating guards after a few minutes to give everyone a chance of playing both roles.



Practice one: connect four

- Add a 6x6-yard square to each corner of the pitch.
- Put players in pairs and give them a ball, except for two defending pairs.
- The pairs with a ball combine with their teammate to get the ball into one of the squares.
- Then they do the same until they have reached all four squares.



Practice one: connect four – continued

- The defending pairs try to stop the others from getting to all four squares, but they can't enter the squares themselves.
- If a defending pair win the ball, they become an attacking pair and try to connect all four squares.
- The pair who have lost the ball, try to win a ball back.



Practice two: end zones

- Create six-yard end zones on your full 45x35-yard pitch.
- Split players into three teams.
- Two teams compete in the area to pass to their target player in an end zone to score.
- The passer then becomes the new target player.
- The third team are bounce players around the area.
- Rotate teams frequently.



Practice three: small-sided game

- Finish the session by going into a game.
- Have three teams with one acting as support players around the outside for the team on the ball.
- This game is an opportunity to notice if players can put their learning into practice and that they've improved their ability to move with the ball and turn.

Week six: positioning to turn

This session will help players:

- understand the need to have appropriate positioning on the pitch, and correct body shape, to move and turn with the ball
- recognise space to dribble through
- change direction and speed while moving with the ball.

Coaching points

- Remind players to scan before, during, and after receiving the ball to recognise and exploit the space is around them and notice where their teammates are.
- Ensure your players think about their body shape when they're receiving the ball to provide opportunities to move with the ball positively. An open body shape encourages moving forwards with the ball to attack opponents.
- Ask your players to try and anticipate the turns and movements of their teammates. This allows them to position themselves in between the defender when the ball eventually makes its way towards them.



Arrival activity: gate guards

- Set up multiple gates across your pitch and vary the size of them.
- Have some players as gate guards and the rest as attackers.
- Give each attacker a ball.
- They aim to dribble through gates for a point.
- Guards can't tackle but can tag attackers inside a gate to reset their score to zero.



Practice one: small-sided game

- Use the full 45x40-yard area and put a goal at each end.
- Then let your players take part in a small-sided game.
- Give players freedom to express themselves.
- Observe to make sure they have the right challenge and give praise when they showcase good moving with the ball and turning skills.



Practice two: connect four

- Add a 6x6-yard square to each corner of your pitch for connect four.
- Keep your players in two teams.
- Players work with teammates to pass or dribble into a square for a point.
- When they do that, they then work it into a different square.
- Players are unopposed when in a square.



Practice three: small-sided game

- Finish the session by going back into a small-sided game.
- Use the same area as the last practice, leaving the corner squares in to represent wide areas to cross or pass from.
- Challenge players to think about how they can get into those areas and how they can assist their teammates.